

Slides 2.20: Employability: Soft Skills Superpower

Lesson 2.20, Unit 2. One period. Eleven slides. The Round 2 replay block (Step 1) runs on the board with the 1925 prices from the kit; Slide 2 holds the instructions. Switch to the rest of the deck after the reset cue.

Slide 1: Do now

- Think of the best worker you know. A relative, a coach, someone at a store or a restaurant.
- Write two things they do that make them good at their job.
- One sentence each.
- Three minutes.

Notes: Board is already up when they walk in. Collect four answers and write them in two unlabeled columns: what they can do (task) and how they work (people, problems, showing up).

Slide 2: Round 2, block 1: 1925

- The Gilded Age Market replays. It is 1925. Fresh ledger, fresh \$1,000. Ten minutes.
- Prices: RAIL 56, OIL 56, GAS 32, ELEC 72, STEEL 72, AUTO 48, RADIO 80. The bank still pays 3 percent.
- You know what comes next: the crash, then the bottom. Buy, borrow on margin, or bank it.
- Write the Block 1 line on your replay half sheet (the last page of the Investor Journal). The block closes at the reset cue.

Notes: Round 2, block 1 of 3. The 1925 prices are page 2 of Handout 02.14 - The Gilded Age Market Kit.md; the margin line is open at the Round 6 rule. Answer only “how do I write a trade” questions. Note one trade decision to use as evidence in Step 3.

Slide 3: Two columns

- Column one: what they can do. The task.
- Column two: how they work. Shows up. Explains. Helps. Fixes. Tells the truth.
- Column one is called hard skills.
- Column two is called soft skills.

Notes: Label the two columns from the do now now that the students have named them. “Everything in column two, employers say they cannot teach.”

Slide 4: The six employers name most

- Reliability
- Communication
- Teamwork

- Problem solving
- Adaptability
- Honesty

Image: six small icons in a row: a clock, two speech bubbles, a team huddle, a puzzle piece, a road with a detour arrow, a handshake.

Notes: One line each. Reliable: shows up every shift. Communication: says the order is wrong before it goes out. Teamwork: helps a coworker finish. Problem solving: finds a fix when the register freezes. Adaptability: takes a schedule change without a complaint. Honesty: reports the broken plate.

Slide 5: What the employer actually wrote

- Job ad 1: a local ad with the soft skill words highlighted
- Job ad 2: a second local ad
- Count the soft skill words in each.
- “Companies hire for hard skills and fire for soft skills.”

Image: two real job postings side by side with four or five words highlighted in each.

Notes: Students believe the employer’s own words more than a slide. Pick employers they recognize.

Slide 6: The evidence rule

- A rating with no evidence does not count.
- Evidence is something you did this year in this room.
- A lab role (name it). The Silent Measurement Challenge. The \$40 project. The Gilded Age Market. A class job.
- Leave a row blank rather than make it up.

Notes: Say the rule twice. Model one row on Slide 7.

Slide 7: Model row

- Skill: Teamwork
- Rating: 3
- Evidence: “As Prep Cook in Lab 2, I had the toppings ready before the Head Cook asked.”
- Sentence starter: “In ___ (lab, game, or project), I ___.”

Notes: Then eight minutes of silent rating. Circulate with the clipboard.

Slide 8: The scale

- 1 = Not yet. I do not do this much.
- 2 = Sometimes.
- 3 = Most of the time.
- 4 = Every time, even when it is hard.

Image: four faces from neutral to confident under the four numbers.

Notes: Leave this up during Step 3 next to Slide 7 if two screens are available; otherwise flip between them once.

Slide 9: One skill to grow

- Pick one skill. Not your highest.
- Where I will practice it this year (the next lab, Unit 3 babysitting, Unit 5 sewing team, a class job).
- What I will do differently (something a person could see).
- How I will know it worked.

Notes: The next lab rotates roles. A student who was Prep Cook can ask to be Station Manager. Push for a place this year, not “in high school.”

Slide 10: Pair share

- Read your plan to your partner.
- Partner asks one question: “How will you know it worked?”
- Fix your last line if you could not answer the question.
- Finished early? Act out one of the six skills in a 30-second scene. Your table names it.
- Three minutes.

Slide 11: Exit card

- The skill I rated highest and my evidence.
- The skill I am growing and where I will practice it.
- One soft skill I saw a classmate use today (the skill, not the name).
- Three people read line three aloud.

Notes: Sort the cards: “got it” has an event behind every rating; “needs more” has a rating with no event. Tomorrow the “needs more” students get one minute at the desk during the do now.